

## NOVALITY STORE

handmade crochet patterns

# Shelby the Sea Turtle Bag Charm

A pocket sea turtle on a keyring - the classic market impulse buy. Under half an hour, a couple of grams of yarn, and the head and flippers are worked straight into the shell so there is almost nothing to sew.

30 minutes

Easy

~3 g of yarn



### FINISHED SIZE

- About 3.7 cm (1.5 in) across the flippers, 3.2 cm long and 1.9 cm deep.
- DK cotton on a 2.5 mm hook; shell and underside both finish at 24 stitches.
- A bigger 5.7 cm version is included.

Design Code NS 09

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## PATTERN OVERVIEW

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### SAFETY FIRST

Two 4 mm safety eyes are small parts. At this size French knots are the better fit (see section 4). Not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71; for children under 3 use French knots.

The keyring is the other hazard: attach it through TWO stitches at the back of the shell and knot the yarn inside - a charm that comes off a bag is a small part with a metal ring.

## MATERIALS

- Shell yarn: DK / light worsted (#3) cotton, about 1 g - sage, teal, mustard or rust.
- Body yarn: DK cotton, about 1 g in contrast cream, sand or pale green.
- Hook: 2.5 mm.
- Eyes: two 4 mm safety eyes or two black French knots.
- Also: a pinch of polyfill (under 1 g), tapestry needle, one 25 mm keyring or lobster clasp per turtle.

## GAUGE

Gauge: about 3.5 mm per stitch and 3.2 mm per round. The whole charm is 203 stitches (~3 m of DK); 24 stitches = a 26.7 mm disc that sets the size.

## ABBREVIATIONS

**MR** magic ring

**ch** chain

**sc** single crochet

**hdc** half double crochet

**inc** increase (2 sc in one st)

**dec** invisible decrease

**sl st** slip stitch

**BLO** back loop only

**FO** fasten off

**(n)** stitch count at round end

## CONSTRUCTION & TECHNIQUES

Start in a magic ring and work continuous spiral rounds with a marker - no joins, no chain 1 between rounds.

**1. Magic ring & spiral**

Start in a magic ring and work continuous spiral rounds with a marker - no joins, no chain 1 between rounds.

**2. Back loop only (BLO)**

Work into the far loop only; the unused loops form a raised ridge. On the shell that ridge is the rim - it makes the dome read as a shell rather than a bun.

**3. Clusters into one stitch**

The trick of the head and flippers: work every stitch of the group into ONE stitch of the previous round so they share an anchor and fan into a bump. Each cluster consumes one stitch and produces as many as it contains - so a 24-stitch round produces 35.

**4. Whip stitch & French knots**

Join shell and underside with an even whip stitch so the seam does not pucker. Eyes: bring the needle up, wrap the floss once or twice around the needle, push back down close by and pull slowly.

**INSTRUCTIONS****1. Shell - DK cotton (sage, teal, mustard or rust)**

| Rnd       | Instruction                   | Sts         | Note                 |
|-----------|-------------------------------|-------------|----------------------|
| <b>R1</b> | 6 sc in MR                    | <b>(6)</b>  | -                    |
| <b>R2</b> | inc in each st around         | <b>(12)</b> | -                    |
| <b>R3</b> | [sc, inc] x 6                 | <b>(18)</b> | -                    |
| <b>R4</b> | [2 sc, inc] x 6               | <b>(24)</b> | -                    |
| <b>R5</b> | BLO sc around                 | <b>(24)</b> | rim ridge            |
| <b>R6</b> | sc in each st around, then FO | <b>(24)</b> | FO with a 30 cm tail |

Before joining, embroider five or six shallow V shapes in a darker shade across the dome - two minutes, and the difference between a turtle and a green blob.

**2. Underside - contrast flat disc**

| Rnd       | Instruction           | Sts         | Note                                          |
|-----------|-----------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>R1</b> | 6 sc in MR            | <b>(6)</b>  | -                                             |
| <b>R2</b> | inc in each st around | <b>(12)</b> | -                                             |
| <b>R3</b> | [sc, inc] x 6         | <b>(18)</b> | -                                             |
| <b>R4</b> | [2 sc, inc] x 6       | <b>(24)</b> | do NOT fasten off - work head & flippers next |

**Head & flippers (work from the live edge)**

| Rnd       | Instruction                                                                                                                                                               | Sts         | Note            |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------|
| <b>R5</b> | 3 sc, (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) in next st, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 3 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 3 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 2 sc | <b>(35)</b> | head & flippers |

This consumes  $3+1+4+1+3+1+4+1+3+1+2 = 24$  stitches (closing the disc) and produces 35. The first, four-stitch bump is the HEAD; the four smaller bumps are flippers. Sl st in the next stitch and FO with a 20 cm tail. The bumps land on stitches 4, 9, 13, 18 and 22, placing the front flippers either side of the head.

### 3. Face - read before you join

The head bump is only ~7-10 mm across, and a 4 mm safety-eye washer (6-7 mm) often will not fit inside it. Use two small black FRENCH KNOTS, 2 stitches apart, low on the head bump. If you do use safety eyes, place them 1 stitch apart and seat the washers BEFORE joining - once the shell is on you cannot reach inside.

The BLO rim ridge and embroidered V markings turn the dome into a shell.



On the hook - what your rounds should look like as they grow

## FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

- Joining the shell (section 5): fix the eyes first. Hold the shell to the underside, wrong sides together, head pointing away from the shell's tail. Whip-stitch with the shell's 30 cm tail, matching 24 to 24 - NOT 24 to 35: the underside's outer round has 35 stitches but only 24 anchor positions (19 plain + 5 clusters). Put one shell stitch against each anchor; at a bump, pass through the BASE stitch the bump was worked into, not the bump itself.
- Add a small pinch of stuffing about three-quarters of the way round (keep it flat - the shell holds only ~8 cm<sup>3</sup>). Weave in ends. Attach the keyring through TWO stitches at the back, opposite the head, and knot inside.

## TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Flippers uneven.**  
Count the plain runs between bumps: 3, 4, 3, 4, 3, then 2 at the end.
- **Keyring pulls out / too fat to hang.**  
Attach through two stitches and knot inside. Use less stuffing so the charm stays flat against a bag.

- **Shell and base won't pair.**

Count anchor positions (19 plain + 5 bumps = 24), not the 35 outer stitches.

## HELPFUL TIPS

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### **Bigger Shelby (~5.7 cm across)**

Work the shell to 42 stitches: Rnd 1 (6), Rnd 2 (12), Rnd 3 (18), Rnd 4 (24), Rnd 5 [3 sc, inc] x 6 (30), Rnd 6 [4 sc, inc] x 6 (36), Rnd 7 [5 sc, inc] x 6 (42), Rnd 8 BLO sc around (42), Rnd 9 sc around (42). Work underside Rnd 1-7 the same to 42 stitches, and do not fasten off.

Underside Rnd 8 (head & flippers): 7 sc, (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) in next st, 8 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 7 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 8 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 7 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st = 53 stitches, consuming all 42 anchors. Join 42 to 42 by the same rule as the small version. Allow 45-50 minutes and about 4 g of yarn.

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### Safety reminder

Shelby uses 4 mm safety eyes (French knots recommended at this size) and a metal keyring. Sold as a keyring/bag charm; not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71. For children under 3 use French knots, attach the ring through two stitches and knot inside.

## Happy crocheting!

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